Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida Reid

Name	Amber Wilson
Occupation	Carer
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	12 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Amber Wilson and I am 35 years old.

3. In 2015, I was accepted into the WA National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS). I was initially diagnosed with mixed physical and psychosocial, I have recently been diagnosed with Autism Disorder in 2020 by Dr Ritu Campbell.

4. In November 2018, I was accepted as a participant of the NDIS and was given my NDIS number 430971573. My first plan was from 26 November 2018 to 10 June 2019 which was to the value of $5,433.26. My current NDIS plan is from 9 June 2022 to 9 June 2023 which is to the value of $285,015.23.

5. My understanding of the NDIS is to provide funding to pay for services in assisting me and my children with everyday living.

6. Up until May 2022, I was the sole carer and plan nominee for my three children James Wilson (James), Tobias Wilson (Tobias) and Yasmine Wilson (Yasmine). I solely managed all of their National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) plans and provider services.

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7. In May 2022 I was no longer the carer or plan nominee for James Wilson.

Tobias Wilson

8. In June 2016, Tobias met access for the WA NDIS until he aged out of the early intervention supports, then he later met access for the National Disability Insurance Agency (NDIA).

9. In May 2020, I completed a Verbal Access Request (VAR) for my son Tobias who was accepted to the NDIS with a diagnosis of Global Developmental Delay (GDD) and given a NDIS number 431019083. Dr Ritu Campbell, Clinical Psychologist later diagnosed Tobias with Level 3 Autism in November 2020.

10. Tobias's first plan was from 09 June 2020 to 18 August 2021 which was to the value of $17,155.77. His current plan is from 07 June 2022 to the 07 June 2023 which is to the value of $126,413.57.

11. My understanding of the NDIS is to provide funding to pay for services in assisting Tobias with everyday living and supports with his disabilities.

Yasmine Wilson

12. In August 2018, I was contacted by the NDIA to transition Yasmine, who was a participant of the WA NDIS to the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS).

13. On 22 August 2018 Yasmine was accepted as a participant of the NDIS, with a diagnosis of GDD and was given a NDIS number 430971583. Her doctors who diagnosed her with Level 2 Autism in December 2020 were Dr Ritu Campbell Clinical Psychologist, Dr Andrew Savery, Paediatrician, and Wendy Marshall, speech pathologist.

14. On 25 November 2018, I had a meeting with a person at the NDIS who assisted me in creating my daughter Yasmine's first NDIS plan. Her first plan was from 26 November 2018 to 25 November 2019 which was to the value of $55,971.93. Her

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current NDIS plan is from 07 June 2022 to 07 June 2023 which is to the value of $117,354.81.

15. My understanding of the NDIS is to provide funding to pay for services in assisting Yasmine with everyday living and supports for her disabilities.

James Wilson

16. In August 2018, I was contacted by the NDIA to also transition James, who was a participant of WA NDIS to the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS).

17. On 22 August 2018 James was accepted as a participant of the NDIS, with a diagnosis of Autism and was given a NDIS number 430972056. James was diagnosed a few years prior with Autism in 2014 or 2015.

18. On 25 November 2018, I had a meeting with a person at the NDIS who assisted me in creating my son James's first NDIS plan. His first plan was from 26 November 2018 to 15 January 2020 which was to the value of $18,299.84.

19. My understanding of the NDIS is to provide funding to pay for services in assisting James with everyday living and supports for his disabilities.

20. In May 2021, Yasmine's previous Support Co-ordinator who was called Zelda Edwardes referred me to someone called Vida Reid (Vida), which was via an email, to use Forward Focus Group (FFG) as a provider.

21. On the 18 May 2021, I received an email from Vida email – vida@ffg.net.au, stating they "are more than happy to assist".

22. On the 26 May 2021, I received an email from Chloe email – chloe.o@ffg.net.au, containing consent forms for myself and my three children Yasmine, James and Tobias.

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23. A few days later I met up with Chloe and another person, I cannot remember who this other person was, to ask about arranging support co-ordination for my children's plans and myself.

24. On 9 June 2021, I consented for myself and my children to begin receiving services from FFG, I cannot recall signing any service agreements with FFG for myself and my children. I have been able to find signed service agreements which has my signature on them for myself and James, I am unable to locate the service agreements for Tobias and Yasmine.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW001: A COPY OF SERVICE AGREEMENT I SIGNED FOR MYSELF WITH FFG DATED 9 JUNE 2021.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW002: A COPY OF SERVICE AGREEMENT I SIGNED FOR JAMES WITH FFG DATED 9 JUNE 2021.

25. A few days later I began receiving emails from Terri Roberts (Terri) email – terri.r@ffg.net.au regarding support co-ordination.

26. On 22 July 2021, I met with Terri and another person, who I cannot remember, this was to finalise reports regarding my NDIS plan.

27. On 2 August 2021, Terri arranged to have all three children meet with a Behavioural Therapist who was called Luke. In this meeting with Luke, we met him at the FFG office in Armadale where he interacted with all three of my children. This interaction lasted for about an hour; I stayed there the whole time and I never saw Luke after this meeting. Later that day Luke sent me an email titled 'Greetings Therapies Report'. In this email he also mentioned about "copying and pasting" my signature into a new service agreement as long as I consented to his email. I never responded to this email.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW003: A COPY OF THE EMAIL I RECEIVED TITLED 'GREETINGS THERAPIES REPORT' FROM LUKE.

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28. In August 2021, Terri assisted me in some personal changes in my life and with my disability needs, but I know I did not see her very often. I think she would come around to see me about once a fortnight or once a month.

29. During my time with FFG, my children and I only received assistance with getting ready for reviews from Terri.

30. On 29 September 2021, Luke was meant to come see us on Yasmine's birthday for Behavioural Observation, however he did not want to meet us at the park as planned. He did not attend and then a few days later I received an invoice requesting to pay for 36 hours of Positive Behavioural Support.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW004: A COPY OF THE INVOICE I RECEIVED LISTING 36HOURS OF BEHAVIOURAL SUPPORT.

31. Throughout my time with FFG I received multiple emails and phone calls inviting me and my children to participate in free fun activities, when I asked if they would cost me any money, they answered no. I usually responded with a no when asked to attend an activity and I later found out they were using our NDIS plan funds without telling us. These phone calls and emails were constant, and they would pressure me and other participants into participating. I received these calls from multiple people who were working for FFG and I was also made aware that Vida was pressuring her staff into pressuring participants to attend these events. There was an instance where someone called me from FFG six times in 30 minutes right before an activity was about to start trying to get me and my children to attend. This made me feel really overwhelmed, I was initially polite, but they kept harassing me. I told them to "Fuck off and leave me alone".

32. One of these events, they offered my children to go on a 'flower arranging course' which they said was free, I decided to send two of my children; James and Tobias to attend this course, this was the first time I had decided to participate in one of these activities. After these calls and the flower arranging course is when I found out FFG charged our plans multiple times. I later found out they were instructed by Vida to not disclose it was coming out of our plans unless the participants asked

about it explicitly. In another instance they offered my 13-year-old son at the time, to go on a fully paid 'Beer and Beef Festival' which also included an overnight stay at a hotel in the city and a one on one support worker the entire time.

33. On 18 October 2021, I sent a message to my Support Co-ordinator Terri, to see if she was available and that was when I found out she had left FFG. After a few months, I was unhappy with FFG as there were too many lies which got too much, especially when I received a phone call invitation for my 13 year old to attend a Beer and Beef Festival, that was the last straw and I decided to cancel with FFG as my provider.

34. On the 8 November 2021 I sent an email to Vida's email vida@forwardfocusgroup.com.au cancelling my services with FFG due to the circumstances of the harassing phones and emails to attend the fun events and activities.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW005: A COPY OF THE EMAIL I SENT TO VIDA REGARDING CANCELLATION THE INVITIATION FOR MY 13 YEAR OLD TO ATTEND A BEER AND BEEF FESTIVAL DATED 8 NOVEMBER 2021.

35. On the 8 December 2021, I was still receiving invoices from FFG however I had cancelled my support with them in November 2021.

36. On 16 February 2022, I received an email from Honey Nguyen email- honey@ffg.net.au stating they were thanking me for attending their "FFG Sea Dream Valentines Day Cruise on the 13th Feb 2022!". No one in my family attended this cruise as I had cancelled my services with FFG in November 2021. I responded to this email asking them to stop emailing me.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW007: A COPY OF THE EMAIL RECEIVED FROM FFG WITH INFORMATION OF THE VALENTINES DAY CRUISE.

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37. On 17 February 2022, I received an email from my previous Support Co-ordinator, who copied me into an email which she sent to honey@ffg.net.au regarding unpaid invoices sent by FFG.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE AW008: A COPY OF THE EMAIL SENT TO HONEY@FFG.NET.AU FROM MY PREVIOUS SUPPORT CO-ORDINATOR TERRI.

38. To the best of memory, I believe sometime in December 2021, I received a form of communication from Vida, I do not remember if it was a phone call, text message or email. Vida contacted me and threatened me that she would sue me for slander and unpaid invoices, I did not respond I just ignored her.

39. On 12 October 2022, Christine Bruckner (Investigator Bruckner) an investigator from the NDIS contacted me to ask about my claims for the NDIS. We had a brief conversation over the phone about these claims.

40. Later that day on 12 October 2022, Investigator Bruckner and I met in person and she showed me a list of claims which were submitted by FFG. I was able to see on the list, claims for 'Capacity Building and Training in Self-Management and Plan Management' and 'House Cleaning And Other Household Activities' have been made by FFG. I can confirm I have never received these services from FFG.

41. My children and I have never received any of the listed services which were shown to me by Investigator Bruckner on 12 October 2022. I could see there were claims for 'STA And Assistance (Inc. Respite) - 1:1 – Weekday' for the dates 23 August 2021 and 24 August 2021, I can say these services were never provided by FFG as all three children and I were staying with a family member at that time.

42. The only services my family and I received as a collective from FFG, were Support Co-ordination once a fortnight or a month from Terri and the other was the observation on the 2 August 2021 where Luke interacted with all three children.

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43. I received multiple emails containing invoices for a company called "The Hive" ABN:96651140108. I never signed a service agreement with The Hive, I never received any services from them, and I never gave them permission to claim from my NDIS plan.

44. This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Amber Wilson

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 1:15pm on 12 October 2022 at an address in Perth in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Christine Bruckner – Fraud Investigator
Perth Western Australia

Amber Wilson

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